iFAMS Integrated Financial and Acquisition Management System Service

FSC Financial Services Center

Creating an Advance Billing Document Transcript

VA | U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

Document Control

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2/27/2025	DR	1.0	Initial document creation

WELCOME AND COURSE INFORMATION

Welcome to the “Create an Advance Billing Document” microlearning. When you are ready to get started, click the “Start” button to begin.

This microlearning will cover what an Advanced Billing Document is and how to create one. You will also have an opportunity to practice what you learned.

By the end of this microlearning you will be able to:

- Describe an Advanced Billing Document is, and
- Execute the process to create an Advance Billing Document

CONTEXTUAL BACKGROUND

When a bill is created manually due to advance billing or billing outside the normal billing cycle, an advance billing document (BME) is needed. A BME is a billing document that has either been manually created within iFAMS or has been converted from FMS.

A user can create a BME for multiple reasons such as reimbursement advances, conversion billing documents, revenue receivables, and overpayments.

For this training, we will focus on the process of creating an advance billing document for revenue receivable. Revenue receivables are created in scenarios involving non-federal leasing activity, miscellaneous revenue collection, and/or for seller reimbursable agreement activity. Revenue receivables for federal reimbursable agreement activity are billed or collected via IPAC.

An advance billing document must go through one level of approval before it is processed: Additional approval is required from FSC based on a dollar threshold. If the dollar amount is between $100 million and $1 billion it needs FSC FAS Director Level Approval. If the dollar amount is greater than $1 billion it needs FSC SES Level Approval and FSC FAS Director approval.

STEPS TO CREATING AN ADVANCE BILLING DOCUMENT

For this example, we will create an Advance Billing Document (BME) for a revenue receivable of an ex-employee debt. Remember to save frequently to ensure you do not lose any of your work.

To create an Advance Billing Document in iFAMS, open the “Transactions Menu” by clicking on the “Transaction Icon” in the Menu Bar, and click on “Accounts Receivable,” “New,” then the “Billing Document” menu item.

This will open the New Billing Document menu page. Type “BME” in the Document type box. Enter in the Security Organization. In this example, we are using B32903010. Then, click the 'Generate'

button to the right of the 'Document Number' data field. This will populate a new document number in iFAMS for this BME. Click “Finish” to move to the next section.

Under the Header tab, in the Vendor Information section, enter in the Vendor code. In this example, we are using “M00001565 – Ex0001.” In the Printing section, enter the Text Code. For this example, we are using “STANDARD.” Standard is the code used for non-IPAC bills. In the collection section, enter the Disbursing Office. In this example, we are using “VA.” Enter in the System ID. For this example, we are using “MANUAL.” Enter in the description. For this example, we are using “FEHB Debt.”

Then, click the “Header Accounting Lines” tab. Click “Add” to create an accounting line, this will take you to the Header Accounting Line page. Then, ensure that the Billing Status is set to “Unbilled.” This will change to ‘Billed’ after the Bill Generation (ARBILLGEN) runs. Enter in the Transaction Type. For this example, we are using “GF” which stands for General Funds. Enter in the Receivable Type. Use ‘NONFED’ for bills with commercial vendors, ‘EMP’ for a bill to an employee, or “RESTITUTION” for a court-ordered restitution bill. For this example, we are using “EMP.”

In the Line Amounts section, enter the Initial Amount. For this example, we are using “$1,000”. When using iFAMS and entering Accounting Dimensions, it is best practice to copy and paste the Accounting Dimensions Template code or use the search function to find it. Typing in the Accounting Dimensions template code can lead to it not being accepted due to human error. Enter the template. Select “Default” to auto-populate the accounting information.

Then, ensure the “Accounting Dimensions” are populated and, enter the “Revenue Source Code (RSC).” For this example, we are using “920N02.” Enter in comments to print. For this example, we are using “FEHB Debt.” Then, verify that the Print Comments on Bills drop-down is set to “True” and that the Print Comments on Dunning Letters box is checked. In the Text Code field, enter “STANDARD” as this is a non-IPAC bill.

In the DMS Debt Classification drop-down, select the relevant debt classification. For this example, we are using “MD – Miscellaneous Debt.” In the DMS Debt Type drop-down, select the relevant debt-type. For this example, we are using “AD – Administrative Debt.” In the Consumer/Commercial drop-down select either Commercial or Consumer based on the vendor type. Commercial are vendor types C, F, and N. Consumer is vendor types P, I, E, B, and V. For this example, select “Consumer”. For more information on Vendor Types, view the iFAMS Debt Management (FSC and DMC) Desk Guide Note: The iFAMS Debt Management (FSC and DMC) Desk Guide resource is subject to change with future enhancements.

In the User Defined Fields group box, enter the FMS Cost Center. For this example, we are using 304000.

Then, click the Office Addresses tab. Click “Add”, this will take you to the Office Address page. Select the Office Type drop-down menu and select “Remit To.” Then, enter in the appropriate Office Code and Address Code. NCA staff will enter ‘NCAREMIT’, FSC will enter ‘FSCREMIT’, and VBA GOE will enter ‘DMC189’ on bills created by their respective organizations. For this example, enter “DMC189.” Enter in the office code to the right of the address code. For this example, we are using DMC189PO. Select “Default Mailing Address.” Select “Save.”

Click the “Ellipsis” at the bottom of the page. Select “Attachments”. In the upload files section, click on “Click or Drag Files here.” Select the “Example Attachment” file to upload and select “Open.” Select “Apply” then close attachments window by selecting “X.”

Click “Save,” and “Verify Form.” Resolve any errors, if applicable, and select “Submit.” Your BME has now been submitted successfully.

PRACTICE ENVIRONMENT

Now, it’s your turn. You will need to carry out the reviewed steps to create an Advance Billing Document. You will be directed to the Create an Advance Billing Document Sandbox Environment. In this environment, you are not timed or graded. However, you will get feedback based off your selections as you progress through the practice.

Take time now to review any of the previously presented content and download the Create an Advance Billing Document Process Guide now available on your screen. When you are ready, click the “Begin” button to enter the sandbox environment.

WRAP UP

Congratulations! You have completed the Create an Advance Billing Document training! In this course we described what an Advance Billing Document is, outlined the process to efficiently create one, and gave you some practice so you are able to execute the steps in your day-to-day. Come back any time to review the content or to practice creating an Advance Billing Document. For further information and additional resources, please visit the iFAMS Guides and Resources SharePoint site.

Please provide feedback for the course using the course evaluation survey so we can continue to improve training efforts.